SEO ARCADE · SEO SOP

Test an AI Detector's False Positive Rate on Your Own Content

Objective

A false positive rate for each detector you use, measured on text like the text you publish, plus a written rule for what a flag does and doesn't trigger. Jon sells a detector. This method lets you skip taking his word for it.

> *"Those are painful in the world of writing." - Jon Gillham, Originality.ai, on false positives (recorded September 2024)*

Key Steps

1. **Write down the call you're testing:** what a flag would change, and whether you're guarding against missed AI or a wrongly accused writer. (inferred)
2. **Build a known human pile** you can vouch for: drafts you watched get written, pieces that predate AI writing tools. (inferred) Don't scrape recent pages. Jon, in 2024: no path to "certainty that that was an exclusively human created data set."
3. **Build a known AI pile of the same size:** same topics and formats, the models your writers could reach. (inferred) Include paraphrased text, as Originality's open benchmark does.
4. **Format both piles for the tool.** github.com/OriginalityAI/AI-detector-research-tool takes .txt folders or a CSV: `text,dataset,label`. Trap: the code reads `dataset`, not `label`. Any row without "human" there scores as AI. Use `human-blog` and `ai-blog`.
5. **Run every detector on the same files.** Python 3.9+, `pip install -r requirements.txt`, `python main.py`, your API keys. Last repo push: May 2024, so test a few rows first. (inferred)
6. **Sort every call into the grid.** Known AI + predicted AI = true positive. Known human + predicted AI = false positive. Known AI + predicted human = false negative. Known human + predicted human = true negative. The code counts a score above 0.5 as AI.
7. **Read the false positive rate first:** false positives / all known human samples. 10 flags on 200 human samples = 5% (example arithmetic, not a result). Then compare F1 across detectors.
8. **Write the rule before the next flag.** A flag opens a review and doesn't close one (judgment). Why did it flag? Jon: "Our answer is we don't know." Ask for drafts, notes and version history. (inferred)

Cautionary Notes

- The tool and benchmark come from a vendor in the test. Read the code and run your own pile as well.
- Don't borrow a rate. Jon gave no false positive rate on tape, so this SOP has none.
- A byline isn't proof. One mislabeled sample skews your result. (inferred)
- Small piles mislead: 1 flag in 20 reads as 5%, one more reads as 10%.
- Don't swap in your gut. Jon: "we're massively overconfident."
- Get permission before sending client drafts to third-party APIs. (inferred)
- This measures the detector, not whether a page will rank.

Tips for Efficiency

- Trial run on a slice of the 2,000-sample benchmark in the repo's `benchmark_set` folder. (inferred)
- Estimate the bill: rows x detectors x each vendor's API price. (inferred)
- Name rows by content type (`human-email`) to spot which format draws flags. (inferred)
- Keep the set unchanged. Re-run when a vendor ships a new model. (inferred)
- Matrix step failed? The README says run `python matrix.py`.

Source: Jon Gillham, Originality.ai, on the Unscripted SEO Podcast with Jeremy Rivera (recorded September 2024). Tool details checked against its public repository November 6, 2026; the tool was not run for this SOP. SOP: seoarcade.com/seo-sop-test-ai-detector-false-positive-rate · recap: seoarcade.com/ai-content-seo-words-data-jon-gillham · unscriptedseo.com. Details marked (inferred) are execution detail added by SEO Arcade.